

Kirsten Kelly

(224) 600 - 2044 | kirstenkdebate@gmail.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/kirsten-kelly-gc/> | <https://kirsten-kelly.github.io/>

Education

Grinnell College | Grinnell, IA

Graduation Date: May 2029

- Majors: Political Science and Economics
- Founders' Scholar

Professional Experience

Independent Academic Tutor | Self-Employed | Northbrook, IL

August 2022 - Present

- Built revenue-generating tutoring business from the ground up by developing strategic marketing approach and referral network, growing client base to 15+ students
- Manage scheduling, pricing strategy, invoicing, and parent communications while maintaining quality standards
- Conduct initial diagnostic assessments to determine skill gaps and create individualized lesson plans aligned with each student's academic goals in math, writing, reading, and test prep

Lifeguard | Northbrook Park District | Northbrook, IL

May 2024 - Present

- Supervise 100+ daily pool patrons while maintaining emergency readiness and enforcing safety protocols
- Collaborate with 10-11 member teams to coordinate coverage, communicate effectively under pressure, and respond to emergency situations

Volunteer Math Tutor | Glenbrook North | Northbrook, IL

August 2023 - May 2025

- Delivered 84+ hours annually of instruction to students, developing learning plans and tracking progress
- Enhanced student understanding through targeted problem-solving skills and individualized instruction
- Applied effective presentation skills to explain complex subjects, fostering student comprehension and academic success

Leadership and Campus Activities

Student-Athlete | NCAA DIII Track and Field | Grinnell College | Grinnell, IA

August 2025 - Present

- Balance 20+ hours of weekly athletic training with rigorous academic schedule, demonstrating exceptional time management and discipline
- Contribute to campus diversity initiatives through Student Athletes Leading Social Change programming
- Represent Grinnell College in high jump and short sprints as a part of the Midwest Conference

Analyst | Pioneer Capital Investments | Grinnell College | Grinnell, IA

October 2025 - Present

- Conduct equity research and portfolio management for \$380,000 student-run fund, analyzing financial statements, market trends, and economic indicators to identify investment opportunities
- Monitor macroeconomic trends and Federal Reserve policy impacts on portfolio positioning and sector allocation

Competitor | Debate Union | Grinnell College | Grinnell, IA

September 2025 - Present

- Synthesize economic data, academic research, and policy analysis into evidence-based arguments under time constraints
- Evaluate trade-offs between competing policy objectives and assess practical implementation challenges

Witness/Attorney | Mock Trial | Grinnell College | Grinnell, IA

September 2025 - Present

- Deliver persuasive oral arguments and adapt cross-examination tactics based on real-time strategic assessment to achieve a team record of 4-1-3 at our last tournament
- Collaborate across 10-person team to coordinate case theory, witness preparation, and trial execution

Skills and Accolades

- Languages: French (Illinois State Seal of Biliteracy Commendation), Polish (Conversational)
- Technical: R, HTML, Excel
- Certifications: CPR/AED, First Aid, STARguard lifeguard
- Honors: Founders' Scholar, 3x STARguard 5-star Award, National Honors Society